

Write to the Editor

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Digit will publish the best letters on these pages. Letters may be edited for clarity. Please include your complete address in all communication.

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LETTER
OF THE
MONTH

positive, and you've misunderstood them. Your elaboration (as if no one understands the psychology behind the cover page!) clearly reflects that. May I request you to read (be cool!) Navin's comments once again? I can now hear your "Oh... Yeah... That's right..."

The cover was really excellent. Keep it up, *Digit* designers! And, Navin, I'm sure you're checking that cover over again to confirm... I too do that quite often since I got that issue!

Prasanna

Thank you, Prasanna, for giving me an opportunity to rethink myself... I've gone through Navin's mail again, and I must say that while I have not taken enough note of the positive tone there, you've missed Navin's sarcasm.

What seemed a defense—on my part—of the cover design was not really a defence. It was an explanation, and I still say I'm not an expert in such matters: although I do approve of the cover before it goes to print, I leave the psychology behind it to the designers! And coming to that, I have passed on your congratulations to my design team. They're pleased as punch!

— Executive Editor

Beyond Tech

The great enlightened Maharishis of our time are warning everyone that electromagnetic field (EMF) damage to the nervous system and health of the physiology is real. You'll not find Wi-Fi in their *Ashrams*. In the 1990s, significant scientific research linked leukaemia and skin cancer to the EMF coming from poor building wiring. More evidence on damage from mobile phones and other powerful electrical transmitters is coming. The fascination of wireless communication and entertainment is real, but why not open your hearts and mind to the experience of Totality and the Kingdom of Heaven within?

Vidhyapeeth
Uttarkashi

Dear Mr Vidhyapeeth,
As I've heard—and as I see it—EMF having a negative effect on physiology is a controversy-ridden topic, with some people crying themselves hoarse that there is a link, and some doing the same thing to convince people there is none. As a result, I must admit, I cannot say anything for or against the idea.

In regards to all this vis-à-vis what you refer to as the Kingdom of Heaven within, some might subscribe to your view, some might not. We are a technology magazine, and our only aim and duty is to educate and motivate people on that front. We might, perhaps, take an in-depth look

at what the truth really is about wireless radiation and health.

— Executive Editor

The Disc Is In The Mail!

Your team always proves that *Digit* is the best. I've never subscribed to any other magazine all the past five or six years—nothing can make me feel complete with its quality and overall growth. But it's only *Digit* that I've been reading regularly. Every time I think *Digit* is repeating itself or that there's nothing in it to spend my time on, you come up with something new... thanks!

This issue (August '07), though, spoil my holiday. The DVD isn't working. I found nothing wrong at my end. It's not the only problem I've had with your magazine. The December issue, too, arrived with damaged discs. Thank God there was no problem with the anniversary issue... is there anything you can do?

I have some suggestions: please make sure the packaging of the discs and of the June and December special issues is good. Second, always think about those who do not have high-end computers—and you could increase your circulation, helping more people use technology. Then, I am still waiting for a *Fast Track* on programming.

Adding video or Flash-based tutorials can help us understand new software. This is one area *Digit* lacks in.

Shift some reading material to the discs—like *Tips & Tricks* and *Q&A*.

Inderdeep

Hoshiarpur, Punjab

Thanks for your suggestions, Inderdeep—we'll be thinking about them, but there are lakhs of readers to please, and we need to find the best way to please as many of them as possible. I must say, though, that adding something like Flash-based tutorials would be a considerable added expense, one we cannot bear.

We welcome suggestions, though, because that's the only way we know what our readers want. Letters like yours are especially valuable—feel free to write in again, with as many suggestions as you can think of!

Regarding your damaged discs, all you need to do is mail us with your subscriber number and postal address with PIN code, and your replacementss will be on their way!

— Executive Editor

India Online

In your May 2007 issue, the absence of a vernacular Web presence was discussed, and the features of "uRekha" were brought out. It is necessary to bring your notice that there is a single software to create documents in almost all Indian languages, and it's free! Kindly go to www.baraha.com and assess its versatility and utility in a field which, you lament, is neglected. You can inspire enthusiasts to create Web portals using the resources available. The economics of maintaining a Web sites is perhaps the main reason for the current situation.

Here's an extract from that page: *Baraha is a word processing application for creating documents in Indian languages. It is developed with an intention to provide a free software to enable and encourage Indians use their native languages on the computers. Baraha can be effectively used for creating documents, sending emails and publishing web pages. Baraha 7.0 supports Kannada, Devanagari, Tamil, Telugu, Malayalam, Gujarati, Gurumukhi, Bengali, and Oriya scripts.*

"With 35,000 downloads/month, hundreds of thousand users have downloaded Baraha so far. Baraha is used in publications, schools, banks, government and private offices, various Indian organizations and millions of homes around the world."

M N Sathyanarayana Rao

Dear Mr Rao,
Thanks for bringing the site and software to our notice. As we can see, the Baraha software has its utility—it makes it easy to type in several Indian languages using the regular US keyboard layout. There is also a feature where you type in something in English, choose a supported Indian language, and you get character output in that language—which you can then paste into any application. (However, that feature is not quite perfect.) We do encourage our readers to visit www.baraha.com.

I'd also like to say that we made special mention of uRekha because it is gesture-based, making it very easy to learn—in fact, there is hardly any learning required (for supported languages) to be able to input text. That is something that is sure to be appreciated in our villages and other rural areas, where people don't know the English alphabet, or are not comfortable using a keyboard, or both.

— Executive Editor